

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM Engineering | Detection Engineering | CrowdStrike NG-SIEM |
Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | Financial Services

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior cyber security engineer and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) specialist with over five years of experience engineering, tuning, and optimising enterprise SIEM platforms, building detection correlation logic, and leading security operations in complex enterprise environments. In my current senior role at the University of the Arts, London (UAL), I engineer and maintain detection capabilities across both CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and Microsoft Sentinel, authoring Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules, building Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, and driving continuous improvement of SIEM-driven security operations for over 8,000 users. I bring strong expertise in Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), threat detection engineering, identity security, vulnerability management, and incident response, and I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification. I am well placed to deliver senior SIEM engineering capability within a high-performance financial services security team, contributing both technical depth and practical security operations experience from day one.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM (primary platform) - Expert; Microsoft Sentinel; SIEM platform administration, optimisation, and tuning; data model management; correlation search development; dashboard creation
- **Detection Engineering:** Kusto Query Language (KQL) in Microsoft Sentinel; CrowdStrike NG-SIEM detection rules; MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection coverage mapping; behavioural and sequence-based detection logic
- **SOAR:** SOAR playbook development and automation; PowerShell-based automated response workflows; mean time to respond (MTTR) reduction
- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Prevent, Insight, Discover) - Expert; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Security Operations:** Tier 2 and Tier 3 alert triage; threat hunting; incident response (NIST 800-61); forensic investigation; log analysis; attack chain reconstruction
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD); Conditional Access; MFA/SSO; Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); AppCheck; Nessus; full scan-to-remediation lifecycle
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM (8,000-user deployment); Tanium; CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Discover
- **Email Security:** Mimecast; anti-phishing and Business Email Compromise (BEC) detection
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony next-generation firewall; IDS/IPS; WAF/DDoS protection
- **Scripting:** PowerShell (SIEM/SOAR automation, detection rule scripting, bulk remediation workflows)
- **Compliance Frameworks:** ISO 27001; NIST Cyber Security Framework (CSF); CIS Controls; Cyber Essentials Plus; MITRE ATT&CK; FCA security control alignment

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer March 2025 - Present
Oversee and lead SIEM operations for a 8,000-user estate, responsible for platform administration, optimisation, detection rule development, SOAR automation, and continuous improvement of the organisation's SIEM-driven security operations capability.

- Author and maintain detection correlation rules and analytics in both CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, using Kusto Query Language (KQL) to build behavioural, sequence-based, and MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection logic to identify advanced adversary techniques.
- Build, test, and maintain SOAR playbooks and automated response workflows using PowerShell and Logic Apps, integrating with CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel to reduce mean time to respond (MTTR) and remove manual analyst burden from high-volume alert types.
- Lead Tier 2 and Tier 3 incident triage and investigation, using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) to perform log analysis, endpoint forensic triage, and attack chain reconstruction.
- Manage the CrowdStrike Falcon platform across all modules (NG-SIEM, EDR Prevent, Insight, Discover) for full endpoint and network threat detection, behavioural analytics, and automated threat prevention at scale.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to monitor identity-based attack techniques including lateral movement, Kerberoasting, pass-the-hash, and privilege escalation, integrating MDI signals into Microsoft Sentinel for correlated incident detection.
- Govern identity security through Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) Conditional Access, enforcing Zero Trust principles and least-privilege access across on-premises and cloud-hosted financial and academic systems.
- Operate BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to control, audit, and monitor all privileged account activity across the estate, including credential vaulting, session recording, and just-in-time (JIT) access provisioning.
- Conduct vulnerability scanning and management using Tenable.io, Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and AppCheck, producing prioritised remediation plans and tracking findings to closure with infrastructure and cloud teams.
- Contribute to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus audit preparation, ensuring SIEM platform coverage and incident response procedures are documented and aligned to applicable control frameworks.

University of the Arts London (UAL) – Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity
 University of the Arts London (UAL) – Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity, March 2022 – March 2025
 Investigating alerts, performing correlation analysis, and producing structured incident reports for management and compliance purposes.

- Developed and enhanced KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving alerting fidelity, expanding MITRE ATT&CK detection coverage, and reducing false positive rates through ongoing rule tuning and review cycles.
- Built and maintained SOAR playbooks for automated alert enrichment and initial response actions, reducing analyst workload and enabling faster triage of high-volume, repeatable security events.
- Led incident response investigations for phishing, malware, ransomware, and data exfiltration events, performing full lifecycle response in line with NIST 800-61 and producing post-incident reports with recommendations for detection improvement.
- Deployed and tuned Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 endpoints, integrating MDE telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for correlated cross-platform detection and automating response via EDR-SIEM integration.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, producing risk-based remediation plans and supporting the annual ISO 27001 internal audit process.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO policies to enforce identity security standards across the estate, and supported BeyondTrust PAM administration for privileged account governance.

HGX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) – IT Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure
 HGX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) – IT Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure, February 2021 – March 2022
 Delivered security, SaaS and FinTech, and IT engineering services to a SaaS FinTech environment, supporting the security of financial data processing systems and supplier management platforms.

- Monitored security event logs from Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), endpoint agents, and network devices, triaging anomalous activity and escalating confirmed incidents for investigation.
- Supported SIEM alert triage and incident response processes, contributing to the organisation's security operations capability in a fast-growth, globally distributed FinTech business.

- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus, prioritised findings by business risk, and co-ordinated remediation with DevOps and infrastructure teams to maintain security compliance.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) identity governance, access reviews, MFA enforcement, and Conditional Access policies to support SOC 2 and ISO 27001 compliance requirements.
- Contributed to security documentation, change management, and audit evidence preparation in support of the organisation's security certification objectives.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered and deployed a comprehensive SIEM detection rule library in both CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, achieving measurably improved MITRE ATT&CK framework coverage across endpoint, identity, and cloud attack vectors and reducing false positive alert rates.
- Built and optimised SOAR automation playbooks using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for common high-volume alert types and freeing analyst capacity for complex threat investigations.
- Delivered 100 per cent CrowdStrike Falcon EDR coverage across 8,000+ endpoints at UAL, providing real-time cloud-delivered threat intelligence, behavioural analytics, and automated prevention for the entire estate.
- Architected and deployed the Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, and Microsoft 365 Defender) across 8,000 users, creating a fully integrated SIEM/XDR detection capability with correlated signals across endpoint, identity, and email attack surfaces.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) controls across the estate, introducing credential vaulting, session recording, and just-in-time (JIT) access provisioning to reduce risk from insider threats and privileged account compromise.
- Achieved and maintained ISO 27001 alignment and Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, demonstrating effective SIEM and security control coverage to external assessors.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP85,000–GBP100,000 | Hybrid (London, UK)